GRADE 11 / English HL / English

Analyse persuasion, not just opinion

01 Understand

Learning goals: Distinguish assertion from evidence • Explain an appeal to emotion • Evaluate a persuasive message

A persuasive text tries to influence an audience. Identify the intended audience, purpose and specific choices used to persuade.

An assertion states a claim. Evidence provides a basis for judging it; check whether it is relevant and credible.

Loaded language and rhetorical questions can shape emotion. Explain the likely effect in this particular text rather than merely naming a technique.

Original poster: “Don’t let our library fade. Join Saturday’s book drive. A single book can open a hundred doors.”

Choice	Technique	Possible effect
our library	inclusive language	shared ownership
fade	emotive metaphor	sense of loss
a hundred doors	figurative exaggeration	suggests many opportunities

02 Follow the reasoning

Explain how the poster encourages community participation.

1. “Our” includes readers in a shared community and frames the library as a collective responsibility.

2. The contrast between “fade” and “open” moves from possible loss to opportunity.

3. The clear instruction identifies an action, but readers still need practical details such as place, time and acceptable donations.

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Practise with purpose

03 Try before checking

Use paper or your notebook. Show your reasoning. For written responses, use evidence and explain your choices. Suggested time: 15–20 minutes.

1. Identify the poster’s main request.

2. Is “a hundred doors” reliable numerical evidence? Explain.

3. Suggest one practical improvement to the poster.

04 Check and correct

1. Join Saturday’s book drive.

2. No. It is figurative language expressing opportunity, not a measured outcome.

3. Add a verified venue, time and contact or donation requirements.

Common mistake to avoid

Identifying a device without explaining its effect does not complete a language-analysis response.

Reflect and revisit

Identify one correction in your own words. Attempt a similar question tomorrow without looking at the guide. If you are still unsure, take your attempt to a teacher or tutor.

Coverage and sources

CAPS topic focus: Reading and viewing: critical language awareness

DBE CAPS, Grades 10–12: English. Section 3 content and skills. This is a focused supplement, not a complete syllabus or prescribed literature replacement.

Open the official DBE curriculum reference

Content and visuals: original SmartBridge FET. AI-assisted authoring; subject-teacher and language-specialist review pending. Report an issue with the pack ID enhl-11.